
Cybercrime Case Study: UPI / Online Payment Fraud

❖ Introduction

UPI (Unified Payments Interface) frauds are one of the common cyber-crimes that occur when a hacker manipulates people into sending money or divulging sensitive information like UPI PINs and OTPs. With the rise of digital transactions, UPI frauds are becoming increasingly common, especially among students.

❖ How the Fraud Typically Happens?

1. **Contact:** The victim receives a call or message from someone pretending to be a bank official or service provider.
2. **Urgency:** The fraudster creates panic by mentioning issues like account problems, refunds, or failed transactions.
3. **Trap:** The victim is asked to click a link or accept a UPI collect request.
4. **PIN Entry:** The victim is guided to enter their UPI PIN, thinking it is required to receive money.
5. **Transaction:** The entered PIN actually authorizes a payment, and money is transferred to the fraudster.
6. **Aftermath:** The victim realizes the fraud only after the money is deducted.

❖ Targeted Individuals

College students, elderly persons, and new digital users may be targeted because they may not be aware about how UPI transactions function or may trust this form of communication without verification.

❖ Consequences

The consequences of UPI fraud may include monetary loss, unauthorized transactions, and improper utilization of bank account information. The person may also face mental stress and may not be able to recover the lost money.

❖ Conclusion

In this case, it is important to note that digital awareness is key. One should always be aware that they do not need to enter a UPI PIN to receive money and should always verify suspicious transactions before acting on them.